Geospatial Information Systems Policy

Effective Date:
October 08, 2025

Category:
Software

Scheduled Review:
October 2026

1. Authority

Executive Order 2016-06, Enterprise Information Technology Governance

2. Document Control

This document replaces, in its entirety, the *Geospatial Information Systems Policy*, dated January 6, 2025.

3. Purpose

This Information Technology Policy (ITP) establishes the policy and standards for Geospatial Information Systems (GIS) to increase interoperability and reduce duplication of capabilities and investments across agencies. Computer Aided Design (CAD) software and Global Positioning System (GPS) equipment are not covered by this policy

4. Scope

This policy applies to all offices, departments, boards, commissions, and councils under the Governor's jurisdiction and any other entity connecting to the Commonwealth Network (hereinafter referred to as "agencies").

5. Policy

For definitions of terms found within this document, refer to the *IT Policy Glossary*.

Agencies requiring geospatial software shall only procure software that meets the current product standards as defined within *Geospatial Information Systems Standard.*

Prior to procuring new servers, databases, data storage, or software for geospatial applications, an agency should contact its OA/IT Service Coordinator to determine if the agency's needs can be accommodated through the Geospatial Enterprise Server Architecture (GESA) in order to save costs and leverage enterprise geospatial server resources.

An approved IT policy exception is required prior to any new procurement for geospatial data

storage, servers, or software for new geospatial applications or resources that are otherwise available through OA/IT.

Agencies that are authoring geospatial data shall adhere to the standards and protocols detailed in *Geospatial Information Systems Standard.*

6. Contact

Questions or comments may be directed via email to OA, IT Policy.

7. Exception from Policy

In the event an agency chooses to seek an exception from this policy, a request for a policy exception shall be submitted via the enterprise IT policy exception process. Refer to *IT Policy Governance Policy* for guidance.

8. Revision History

This chart contains a history of this publication's revisions. Redline documents outline the revisions and are available to Commonwealth users only during the drafting process.

Version	Date	Purpose of Revision
Original	01/06/2025	Base Document
Revision	10/08/2025	Minor grammatical updates only The standards document associated with this policy has been updated